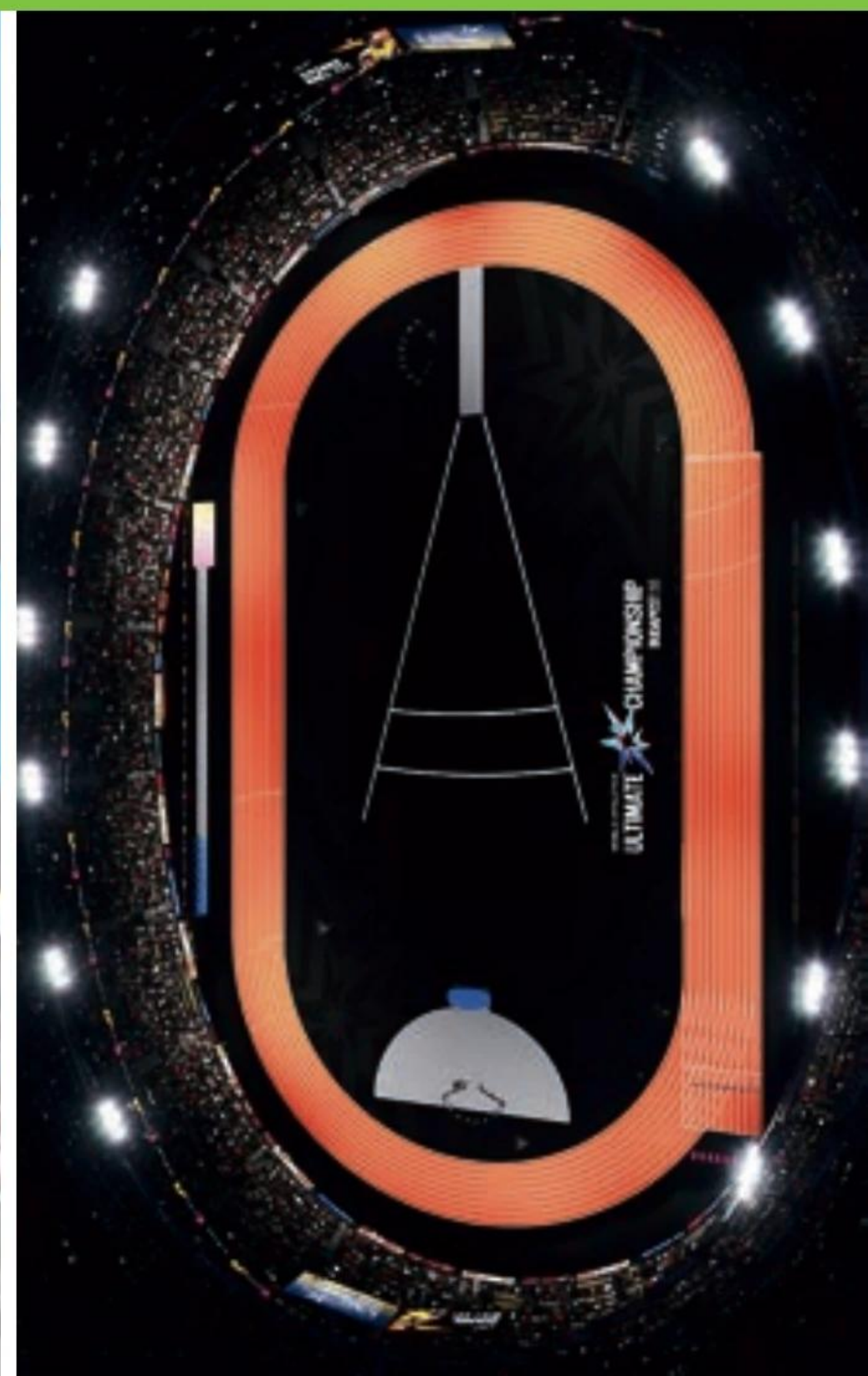




Visual spectacle: A series of innovations was also introduced in the event to generate more interest. When Sri Lankan phenom Rumesh Pathirage (left) hurled the spear to a distance of 91.09m, his yellow javelin could be spotted like never before, as apart from the competition area in use, the entire infield was black (right). AP & WORLD ATHLETICS



preferred semifinal heat and lane live in front of media and fans, with their world ranking determining the order of the picks. For the field events, apart from the high jump and pole vault, the number of attempts for all eight finalists was reduced to two from the usual three before the first stage of elimination. The top six got one more chance, and only the four best competitors could go for a fourth and final effort, putting the onus on the athletes to give their best with every throw and jump.

When Sri Lankan phenom Rumesh Pathirage hurled the spear to a distance of 91.09m, his yellow javelin could be spotted like never before, as apart from the competition area in use, the entire infield was black.

Even the broadcast experience was enhanced with augmented graphics, including projected finishing positions and win probabilities.

Having Olympic champions Noah Lyles and Armand Duplantis as the creative minds behind the athletes'